

DeepSide: A Deep Learning Framework for Drug Side Effect Prediction

ABSTRACT:

Adverse drug reactions (ADRs) are a major cause of failure in drug development, often leading to serious health risks and significant financial losses during clinical trials. Early and accurate prediction of drug side effects is therefore a critical challenge in pharmaceutical research. Traditional computational methods rely heavily on external biological knowledge and manual feature engineering, and often fail to fully utilize large-scale experimental datasets.

In this project, we present DeepSide, a deep learning-based framework for drug side effect prediction that effectively integrates drug chemical structure information and large-scale gene expression data. DeepSide leverages the complete LINCS L1000 dataset, including gene expression profiles obtained under different cell lines, dosages, and time points, without discarding low-quality experiments. The prediction task is formulated as a multi-label classification problem, as a single drug can cause multiple side effects simultaneously.

The framework evaluates multiple deep learning architectures, including multi-layer perceptron, multi-modal neural networks, multi-task learning models, and a convolutional neural network (CNN) based approach using SMILES string representations of drugs. Among these, the SMILES-based CNN model demonstrates the best performance by automatically learning meaningful chemical patterns directly from molecular structures. Experimental results show that DeepSide significantly outperforms existing state-of-the-art methods in terms of prediction accuracy and is capable of identifying potential drug-side effect relationships that are not explicitly recorded in existing databases.

Overall, DeepSide provides an efficient and scalable solution for early detection of adverse drug reactions, supporting safer drug design and reducing risks in the drug development process.

KEYWORDS:

1. Drug Side Effect Prediction
2. Deep Learning
3. Adverse Drug Reactions (ADR)
4. Gene Expression Analysis
5. SMILES Representation